

RULES OF THE ROAD

4.10 | TRAFFIC LAWS

The rules of the road are designed to keep people safe. They prevent traffic incidents by establishing the rules everyone agrees to follow when they use the road. The laws exist to keep road systems moving smoothly.

For the most part, the fundamental rules of the road stay the same. However, traffic laws can change. You can find the most current rules of the road by searching **RCW 46.61** online. For as long as you drive, it is your responsibility to stay informed about the most current rules of the road.

GENERAL DRIVING GUIDANCE

As a driver in Washington state, it's a good idea to keep this general driving guidance in mind:

- Drive on the right side of the road. The only time you might temporarily travel on the left is if you are safely and legally passing another vehicle on a two-lane road.
- **Keep right except to pass.** When there are multiple lanes traveling in the same direction, drive in the right lane. Use the left lane to pass slower traffic.
- Follow speed limit laws, even when using the left lane to pass.
- Remember, carpool lanes are not passing lanes.
- Don't use the shoulders of the road to pass. Unless directed by officials or signs, you shouldn't drive on the shoulder.
- Avoid blocking travel lanes. If you need to stop, keep moving until you can safely pull over.
- Keep moving forward. Don't drive in reverse on the road, even if you miss your turn or exit. It's illegal to back up on a shoulder or freeway.